Send Your Name to Saturn's Moon Titan

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You cannot travel to Saturn's moon Titan yet, but your name can. NASA is asking people to send their names to Titan on its Dragonfly mission.

Dragonfly is a flying robot the size of a large car. It runs on **nuclear power** and NASA plans to launch it in 2028. It should reach Titan in 2034, then fly from place to place across the moon. To send your name, you must sign up before January 15, 2027. The names will be placed on a small chip on the spacecraft.

Titan is a world with an **atmosphere**, rivers and lakes, seasons, and sweeping **dunes**. Dragonfly will study the chemistry there to learn about the building blocks of life. It will visit **dunes** and a young **crater** called Selk, and it will pick up **samples** to test inside the craft.

Dragonfly is not the first visitor to Titan. A lander called Huygens touched down there in 2005 and worked for a few hours. But Dragonfly will be the first flying craft to explore Titan up close for years.

Word Treasure

atmosphere -- The layer of air around a planet or moon.

dunes -- Hills of sand made by the wind.

crater -- A big round hole in the ground made when something crashes into it.

nuclear power -- Energy made from tiny parts inside atoms.

samples -- Small bits of something collected to study.

Background you need

Titan is a moon of Saturn, and it is special because it has an atmosphere, rivers and lakes, and seasons, a bit like Earth.

Dragonfly is a flying robot that will travel across Titan to study its chemistry and look for the building blocks of life.

An earlier lander called Huygens touched down on Titan and worked for a few hours, but Dragonfly will explore for years.

Break it down

WHO: NASA and people who sign up to send their names
WHAT: NASA is sending the flying robot Dragonfly to Titan, and it will carry people's names on a small chip
WHERE: Titan, Saturn's moon
WHY: To study Titan's chemistry and learn about the building blocks of life

Why it matters

Your name could travel to a faraway moon, and what Dragonfly learns may help us understand how life begins.

Test what you remember

1. What is Dragonfly?

- (A) A satellite
- (B) A telescope
- (C) A flying robot
- (D) A rocket

2. What runs Dragonfly?

- (A) Batteries
- (B) Wind
- (C) Nuclear power
- (D) Sunlight

3. When should Dragonfly reach Titan?

- (A) 2005
- (B) 2034
- (C) 2027
- (D) 2028

4. What must you do before January 15, 2027 to send your name to Titan?

- (A) Write a letter to NASA
- (B) Sign up
- (C) Build a rocket
- (D) Visit Saturn

5. What will Dragonfly study on Titan?

- (A) The weather on Mars
- (B) The stars
- (C) The rings of Saturn
- (D) The chemistry there

6. What was the name of the lander that touched down on Titan in 2005?

- (A) Huygens
- (B) Titan
- (C) Selk
- (D) Dragonfly

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: B 4: B 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):